

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-II.2: Comparison, Adverbs, and Numerals

Form regular and irregular comparison, choose a standard-of-comparison construction, derive adverbs, and interpret operational numerals

Stage	Stage II — Core Grammar
Prerequisite	EL-II.1 mastery: resolve pronoun form, antecedent, and clause function independently
Next	EL-II.3, Infinitives and Indirect Statement

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Comparison, adverbs, and numerals

On completing this unit, you can:

- form and decline regular and irregular comparatives and superlatives;
- identify both constructions of comparison and the ablative of degree;
- derive and compare adverbs;
- read the cardinal, ordinal, and distributive numerals needed in rubrics and lessons.

1.1 Comparison exactly stated

The **positive degree** names a quality without comparison (“holy”). The **comparative degree** presents a higher or lower degree (“holier”). The **superlative degree** presents the highest degree or, in some contexts, a very high degree (“holiest” or “very holy”). An **adverb** modifies a verb, adjective, or another adverb rather than agreeing with a noun.

Adjectives and adverbs

A regular comparative adds *-ior* (masculine/feminine) and *-ius* (neuter) to the adjective stem and declines as a third-declension consonant stem: genitive *-ioris*, dative *-iori*, accusative masculine/feminine *-iorem*, ablative singular *-iore*, nominative/accusative neuter plural *-iora*. A regular superlative adds *-issimus*, *-a*, *-um*; stems in *-r* normally add *-rimus* (*pulcher*, *pulcherrimus*); six adjectives in *-ilis* commonly add *-limus* (including *facillimus*, *humillimus*, *simillimus*).

Positive	Comparative	Superlative	Adverbs
<i>bonus</i>	<i>melior, melius</i>	<i>optimus</i>	<i>bene, melius, optime</i>
<i>malus</i>	<i>peior, peius</i>	<i>pessimus</i>	<i>male, peius, pessime</i>
<i>magnus</i>	<i>maior, maius</i>	<i>maximus</i>	<i>magnopere, magis, maxime</i>
<i>parvus</i>	<i>minor, minus</i>	<i>minimus</i>	<i>paulum, minus, minime</i>
<i>multus</i>	<i>plus, pluris</i> n. sg.; <i>plures, plura</i> pl.	<i>plurimus</i>	<i>multum, plus, plurimum</i>

	Singular		Plural	
	M/F	N	M/F	N
Nom.	<i>-ior</i>	<i>-ius</i>	<i>-iores</i>	<i>-iora</i>
Gen.		<i>-ioris</i>		<i>-iorum</i>
Dat.		<i>-iori</i>		<i>-ioribus</i>
Acc.	<i>-iorem</i>	<i>-ius</i>	<i>-iores</i>	<i>-iora</i>
Abl.		<i>-iore</i>		<i>-ioribus</i>

First/second-declension adjectives normally make adverbs in *-e*; third-declension adjectives use *-iter* (or *-er* after *-ns*): *digne, fortiter, prudenter*. The comparative adverb is normally the neuter singular comparative. The superlative adverb is formed from the superlative-adjective stem plus *-e*: *sanctissime, pulcherrime, facillime, optime*.

Comparison and counting

The **standard of comparison** is the person, thing, or group against which the comparative is measured. Parallel terms in the same clause normally use *quam* plus the same case; *quam* may instead introduce an elliptical clause whose noun takes its own function and case, as *quam hæc dilectio [est]*. An ablative without *quam* may express the standard when the compared word is nominative or accusative. *Maior quam frater* and *maior fratre* both mean “greater than the brother.” An ablative such as *multo* states degree of difference: “much greater.” A superlative may take a **partitive genitive**, which names the whole group from which the highest member is selected, or *ex/de* plus ablative.

Cardinal Form		Ordinal Form	
1	<i>unus, -a, -um</i>	1st	<i>primus</i>
2	<i>duo, duæ, duo</i>	2nd	<i>secundus</i>
3	<i>tres, tria</i>	3rd	<i>tertius</i>
4–10	<i>quattuor, quinque, sex, septem, octo, novem, decem</i>	4th–10th	<i>quartus, quintus, sextus, septimus, octavus, nonus, decimus</i>
100	<i>centum</i>	100th	<i>centesimus</i>
1000	<i>mille</i> ; plural <i>milia</i> + genitive	1000th	<i>millesimus</i>

Cardinal numerals answer “how many”; **ordinal numerals** mark position in a sequence (first, second); **distributive numerals** answer “how many apiece”; and **multiplicative adverbs** answer “how many times.” *unus* has genitive *unius*, dative *uni*; *duo* and *tres* decline. Ordinals decline like *bonus*. Distributives answer “how many each”: *singuli, bini, terni*. Multiplicative adverbs include *semel, bis, ter*.

	<i>unus, una, unum</i>	<i>duo, duæ, duo</i>	<i>tres, tres, tria</i>
Nom.	<i>unus, una, unum</i>	<i>duo, duæ, duo</i>	<i>tres, tres, tria</i>
Gen.	<i>unius</i>	<i>duorum, duarum, duorum</i>	<i>trium</i>
Dat.	<i>uni</i>	<i>duobus, duabus, duobus</i>	<i>tribus</i>
Acc.	<i>unum, unam, unum</i>	<i>duos, duas, duo</i>	<i>tres, tres, tria</i>
Abl.	<i>uno, una, uno</i>	<i>duobus, duabus, duobus</i>	<i>tribus</i>

Singular *mille* is indeclinable and directly modifies a noun. Plural *milia* is a neuter plural noun: nominative/accusative *milia*, genitive *milium*, dative/ablative *milibus*; the counted noun is genitive plural.

1.2 Reading the forms in context

Worked example: a substantive superlative in the Gloria

Worked passage ID: W.II.5; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Tu solus Altissimus, Iesu Christe.

Analysis. *Altissimus* is nominative masculine singular superlative of *altus* and is used substantively as a title; *solus* limits *tu*.

Translation. “You alone are the Most High, Jesus Christ.”

Worked example: ablative standard (John 15:13)

Worked passage ID: W.II.6; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Maiorem hac dilectionem nemo habet.

Analysis. *maiores* modifies accusative *dilectionem*. Ablative *hac* is a substantival demonstrative supplying the standard without *quam*, with a second *dilectione* understood: “greater than this [love].” The printed *dilectionem* is accusative and belongs with *maiores*; it is not the noun of the ablative standard.

Translation. “No one has love greater than this love.”

Worked example: ordinal time in the Creed

Worked passage ID: W.II.7; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Et resurrexit tertia die secundum Scripturas.

Analysis. *tertia die* is ablative of time when. Here *dies* is feminine, as shown by feminine ablative *tertia*; *secundum* is a preposition governing the accusative plural.

Translation. “And on the third day he rose again according to the Scriptures.”

Worked example: multiplicative counting (Matthew 26:34)

Worked passage ID: W.II.8; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Priusquam gallus cantet, ter me negabis.

Analysis. Indeclinable adverb *ter* modifies *negabis*: the denial will occur three times. It is not an adjective agreeing with an expressed noun.

Translation. “Before the cock crows, you will deny me three times.”

1.3 Writing laboratory

Write the five irregular comparison rows from memory. Under each, add one Latin phrase that uses the comparative and one that uses the superlative. Copy *Maiorem hac dilectionem nemo habet* three times: first in Missal order, then with *hac dilectione* together, then with *quam hæc dilectio*. Explain why the case changes.

Compose: “Christ is higher than every king” in both comparison constructions; “on the second day” and “for three days”; “they pray more devoutly”; “each priest receives one host.” Use *altus*, *rex*, *dies*, *devote*, *singuli*, *sacerdos*, *hostia*.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 Comparison exactly stated — transfer practice

Connection. An irregular comparison map prevents unrelated stems from being regularized by analogy.

Transfer task. Make a three-column positive–comparative–superlative map for every irregular family printed in the lesson. Beside each comparative, add one standard with *quam* and one ablative-standard frame using lesson vocabulary.

Retrieval check. State the case rule on each side of the two standard constructions.

1.2 Reading the forms in context — transfer practice

Connection. Adjective degree, adverb degree, and degree-of-difference phrases answer different syntactic questions.

Transfer task. For the lesson’s contextual examples, label each comparative or superlative as adjective or adverb, identify what it modifies, and mark any standard or ablative of degree.

Retrieval check. Explain why neuter comparative *-ius* can be either adjectival or adverbial only after context is checked.

1.3 Writing laboratory — transfer practice

Connection. A numeral card links form to the distinct jobs of counting, ordering, and distributing.

Transfer task. Build a one-to-ten cardinal/ordinal card from the lesson, then add three project-composed noun phrases: a count, an ordered day, and one-apiece distribution. Label the numeral family and required agreement or construction.

Retrieval check. Define cardinal, ordinal, and distributive without relying on the example’s English word alone.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Comparison, adverbs, and numerals: parallel forms

Worksheet II.5 — Comparison A

Worksheet ID: II.5

Focus: regular and irregular comparison, adverbs, numeral syntax**Use:** Give exact forms and show whether a standard uses *quam* or ablative.

1. Compare *sanctus*, adjective and adverb.

2. Give all degrees of *bonus* and *bene*.

3. Rewrite *Christus maior est quam propheta* without *quam*.

4. Write in Latin: “on the third day” and “for three days.”

5. **Text:** *Maiorem hac dilectionem nemo habet, ut animam suam ponat quis pro amicis suis.*

*Passage ID: II.5.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.*Parse *maiorem hac dilectionem*; translate.

6. Write in Latin: “The two disciples pray more devoutly than the three servants.”

Worksheet II.8 — Comparison D**Worksheet ID:** II.8**Focus:** regular and irregular comparison, adverbs, numeral syntax**Use:** Give exact forms and show whether a standard uses *quam* or ablative.

1. Compare *facilis* and its adverb.

2. Give all degrees of *parvus* and the corresponding adverbs.

3. Give two Latin versions of “Mary is holier than every disciple.”

4. Give Latin cardinal/adverb pairs for “once, twice, three times.”

5. **Text:** *Priusquam gallus cantet, ter me negabis.*

*Passage ID: II.8.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.*Parse *ter*; translate the whole sentence.

6. Write in Latin: “A thousand believers sing, and two thousand pray.”

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Form twelve prompted comparative/superlative pairs with no more than one error, interpret both standards of comparison correctly in all eight test sentences, and produce cardinal and ordinal forms one through ten at 90 percent accuracy.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-II.3, Infinitives and Indirect Statement.

If it is not met: Worksheets II.6 and II.7 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

Comparison exactly stated — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The map must preserve every lesson stem. After *quam*, the compared members take the cases required by their parallel clause roles; without *quam*, the standard stands in the ablative.

Reading the forms in context — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Each label must name the modified noun or verbal/adjectival center and any governed comparison phrase. The *-ius* form alone does not decide use; agreement and syntactic attachment do.

Writing laboratory — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Cardinals answer how many, ordinals identify position in a sequence, and distributives specify allocation per member or group. The project-composed phrases must use the lesson forms and agree or govern as that construction requires.

CHAPTER 2

Comparison, adverbs, and numerals: parallel forms

Solution II.5 — Comparison A

Worksheet ID: II.5

Focus: regular and irregular comparison, adverbs, numeral syntax**Use:** Give exact forms and show whether a standard uses *quam* or ablative.

1. Compare *sanctus*, adjective and adverb.

Answer / model: *sanctus, sanctior/sanctius, sanctissimus; sancte, sanctius, sanctissime.*

2. Give all degrees of *bonus* and *bene*.

Answer / model: *bonus, melior/melius, optimus; bene, melius, optime.*

3. Rewrite *Christus maior est quam propheta* without *quam*.

Answer / model: *Christus maior est propheta.* Nominative *propheta* becomes ablative *propheta* (same spelling).

4. Write in Latin: “on the third day” and “for three days.”

Answer / model: *tertia die* (ablative time when); *tres dies* or *per tres dies* (accusative duration).

5. **Text:** *Maiorem hac dilectionem nemo habet, ut animam suam ponat quis pro amicis suis.*

Passage ID: II.5.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse *maiorem hac dilectionem*; translate.

Answer / notes: *Maiorem* is accusative feminine singular comparative modifying accusative *dilectionem*; substantival ablative *hac* is the standard, with *dilectione* understood. “No one has greater love than this: that someone lay down his life for his friends.”

6. Write in Latin: “The two disciples pray more devoutly than the three servants.”

Answer / model: *Duo discipuli devotius quam tres servi orant.* *Devotius* is the comparative adverb; *quam* preserves nominative *tres servi*.

Solution II.8 — Comparison D

Worksheet ID: II.8

Focus: regular and irregular comparison, adverbs, numeral syntax

Use: Give exact forms and show whether a standard uses *quam* or ablative.

1. Compare *facilis* and its adverb.

Answer / model: *facilis, faciliior/facilius, facillimus; facile, facilius, facillime.*

2. Give all degrees of *parvus* and the corresponding adverbs.

Answer / model: *parvus, minor/minus, minimus; paulum, minus, minime.*

3. Give two Latin versions of “Mary is holier than every disciple.”

Answer / model: *Maria sanctior est quam omnis discipulus; Maria sanctior est omni discipulo.*

4. Give Latin cardinal/adverb pairs for “once, twice, three times.”

Answer / model: *unus—semel; duo—bis; tres—ter.* The first member counts things; the second counts occurrences.

5. **Text:** *Priusquam gallus cantet, ter me negabis.*

Passage ID: II.8.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse *ter*; translate the whole sentence.

Answer / notes: *Ter* is an indeclinable multiplicative adverb modifying *negabis*. “Before the cock crows, you will deny me three times.”

6. Write in Latin: “A thousand believers sing, and two thousand pray.”

Answer / model: *Mille fideles cantant, et duo milia fidelium orant.* Singular indeclinable *mille* modifies directly; plural *milia* takes partitive genitive *fidelium*.

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-II.2, *Comparison, Adverbs, and Numerals*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet teaches the comparison and numeral systems required by the course corpus, not an exhaustive catalogue of Latin numeral syntax.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-21T17:50:56Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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